

Invitation to Participate: Zewail City Innovation Exhibition 2026

Innovation for Impact: Bridging Research, Industry, and Society Student Handbook & Participation Guide

1. Welcome

The Zewail City Innovation Exhibition 2026 is a platform designed to showcase student excellence in research and innovation, connecting ideas to real-world application and fostering meaningful engagement with industry and society.

For third year in a row, the exhibition continues to highlight outstanding student work while strengthening the link between academic achievement and real-world impact.

As a participant, you are not only presenting a project, but you are also positioning your work within a broader ecosystem of innovation, opportunity, and impact.

2. What This Exhibition Is About

This exhibition brings together students and graduates from Engineering, Science, CSAI, and Business disciplines to present projects that demonstrate:

- Academic rigor.
- Practical relevance.
- Innovation and creativity.
- Real-world impact.

Projects are presented through:

- Research posters.
- Live demonstrations / prototypes.
- Short project videos.

The goal is to communicate not just *what* you built, but *why it matters*.

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3. What You Gain as a Participant

Participating in the exhibition offers you:

- **Visibility:** Showcase your work to academics, industry experts, venture capitalists, investors, government representatives and partners.
- **Feedback:** Receive evaluation from professional judges.
- **Networking:** Engage directly with companies and stakeholders.
- **Opportunities:** Potential pathways for internships, employment, or project support.
- **Recognition:** Compete for awards across multiple categories.

4. Exhibition Format

The exhibition is designed as an **interactive experience**, where participants:

- Present and explain their projects to visitors and judges.
- Demonstrate prototypes or solutions.
- Engage in discussions with industry representatives.
- Respond to questions and feedback.

You are expected to be **actively present at your booth throughout your assigned sessions**.

5. Judging & Evaluation

Projects will be evaluated by academic and industry experts based on:

- Innovation and originality.
- Impact and relevance to real-world problems.
- Usability and feasibility.
- Business or scalability potential.
- Clarity of communication and presentation.

Audience engagement and interaction may also contribute to overall recognition.

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6. Awards & Recognition

Awards will be presented during the closing ceremony, recognizing excellence across key dimensions of innovation, research, and impact.

This is a formal recognition of your work in front of:

- University leadership
- Industry partners
- Peers and stakeholders

Awards Categories

Projects will be recognized across multiple dimensions, including:

- Innovation & Originality.
- Research Excellence.
- Real-World Impact.
- Usability & Feasibility.
- Business & Commercial Potential.
- Communication & Presentation.

What You Gain

Beyond awards, participating students will benefit from:

- **Incubation Opportunity:** A selected group of high-potential teams will be invited to join Zewail City's first student-focused incubator program, supporting the transition from project to venture.
- **Intellectual Property (IP) Support:** Opportunities to receive guidance on intellectual property protection through the Technology Transfer Office.
- **Industry Exposure:** Direct interaction with industry experts for feedback, with potential pathways for internships and employment.
- **Ecosystem Insight:** Exposure to industry needs and challenges, enabling you to identify innovation gaps and opportunities.

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- **Multidisciplinary Engagement:** Opportunity to engage with teams from different disciplines, fostering collaboration and cross-functional thinking.
- **Communication Skills Development:** A platform to practice, demonstrate, and refine your presentation and communication skills in a real-world setting.
- **Certificate of Participation:** Official recognition of your contribution and participation in the exhibition.

7. Your Responsibilities as a Participant

To ensure a successful experience, you are expected to:

Before the Exhibition

- Prepare your **poster, prototype, and/or video**
- Ensure clarity in your **project narrative**
- Practice your **pitch (2–3 minutes explanation)**

During the Exhibition

- Be present at your assigned space.
- Engage actively with visitors and judges.
- Communicate your project clearly and confidently.
- Demonstrate professionalism at all times.

Key Tip

Focus on answering four questions:

- What research problem or market/industry gap are you addressing?
- What is your research methodology and key findings?
- What is your proposed solution, approach, or innovation?
- Why does it matter in terms of scientific, societal, or industry impact?

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8. Exhibition Agenda

Time	Session	Description
09:30 – 10:00	Opening Ceremony	Welcome remarks, introduction of the theme, sponsors, and judging panel.
10:00 – 12:30	Exhibition & Judging	Projects are presented through posters, demonstrations, and videos. Judges conduct evaluations while sponsors and attendees engage with teams.
12:30 – 13:00	Coffee Break	Informal networking and continued light exploration of projects.
13:00 – 15:30	Exhibition & Judging	Continued project presentation and evaluation by judges.
15:30 – 16:30	Networking Lunch	Lunch & dedicated time for interaction, partnership discussions, and talent engagement.
16:30 – 17:30	Industry Panel & Judges Deliberation	Industry panel in the main hall, while judges finalize decisions in a closed session.
17:30 – 18:30	Awards & Closing Ceremony	Announcement of winners, recognition of sponsors, and closing remarks.

9. How to Stand Out

Strong participants typically:

- Communicate their ideas **simply and clearly**.
- Link their project to a **real problem or need**.
- Demonstrate **confidence and engagement**.
- Show awareness of **impact and scalability**.
- Interact actively with visitors and judges.

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10. Additional Preparation & Support

To support your readiness and enhance your experience, the following opportunities are available:

- **Academic Support:** Direct guidance and feedback from your course professor/project advisor to support the development, positioning, and presentation of your project.
- **Pre-Event Pitch Bootcamp:** A structured bootcamp held one week before the exhibition to guide students in presenting their ideas effectively, refining their narratives, and improving delivery.
- **Startup Mentorship Clinic:** A dedicated on-campus mentorship clinic available by appointment, offering tailored guidance on business models, validation, pitching, and development pathways.

11. Participation Timeline & Key Milestones

Milestone	Description	Date	Submission Method
Forum Registration	Submit your project registration for review, acceptance, and selection	20 May 2026	Registration form
Mentorship Clinic Booking & Participation	Book and attend sessions (available twice weekly)	20 May-25 June 2026	Booking portal (TBD)
IP Protection Declaration	Confirm readiness for IP considerations with academic advisor approval	1 June 2026	Registration form
Bootcamp Participation	Register for and attend the pre-event pitch bootcamp	22 June 2026	Registration form
Video Submission	Submit final project video	27 June 2026	TBD
Poster Submission	Submit final poster	27 June 2026	TBD

For Registration: [Link](#)

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12. Presentation & Submission Guidelines

A. Video Specifications	B. Poster Specifications
• Duration: 2 minutes • Format: MP4 • Content should include: ◦ Problem statement ◦ Proposed solution ◦ Key features / innovation ◦ Potential impact • Ensure: ◦ Clear audio and visuals ◦ Subtitles (recommended) ◦ Concise and engaging storytelling	• Size: A1 • Content structure: ◦ Title & team members ◦ Research Problem/ context ◦ Research methodology ◦ Key Findings ◦ Solution/ Prototype ◦ Impact / application • Design tips: ◦ Keep text minimal and readable ◦ Use visuals (charts, diagrams, images) ◦ Ensure clarity from a distance
C. Prototype Guidelines	D. Pitch Presentation (On-Site)
• Ensure your prototype is: ◦ Functional (if applicable) or clearly demonstrable ◦ Safe and stable for display ◦ Easy to explain and interact with • If digital: ◦ Prepare a backup (offline version, screenshots, or demo video) • If physical: Ensure proper setup and transport readiness	• Duration: 2–3 minutes (informal, repeated throughout the day) • Structure: ◦ Problem ◦ Solution ◦ Value / impact • Tips: ◦ Be concise and structured ◦ Avoid technical overload, adapt to your audience ◦ Maintain eye contact and engagement Be prepared for follow-up questions

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13. Final Note

This exhibition is not only about showcasing your work, but also about **positioning yourself within a research and innovation ecosystem.**

It is a moment where:

- Your research & ideas become visible.
- Your work gains recognition.
- Your future opportunities may begin.

14. Event Date: Monday, 29 June 2026

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